

Pamela Dale-Rourke

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PROFILE

Dedicated and compassionate Play Therapist with extensive experience in supporting children and young people through therapeutic interventions. Adept at fostering strong relationships with children, parents, and educators to facilitate effective communication and emotional well-being. Proven ability to develop tailored resources that cater to diverse needs, ensuring accessibility and engagement for all children. Committed to using innovative approaches to therapy, particularly in play-based contexts, to help children express their thoughts and feelings. Skilled in collaborating with multidisciplinary teams to provide holistic support, and I possess a deep understanding of the psychological principles underlying child development and communication. My personal experience with AAC has enriched my perspective, allowing me to empathize with children facing communication challenges.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Service Lead for Schools | Child in Mind, Manchester | October 2016 - Present

- Developed and implemented innovative communication and therapy resources tailored for children in school settings, enhancing their ability to express feelings and needs through visual supports and interactive activities.
- Provided impactful 1:1 Play Therapy and Family Therapy sessions, focusing on psychotherapeutic assessments that effectively informed personalized therapeutic pathways for children and their families.
- Collaborated closely with educators and therapists to create accessible and engaging materials for children with diverse communication and learning needs, resulting in improved educational outcomes.
- Supervised and mentored postgraduate Play Therapy students, offering extensive training and guidance in the effective use of therapeutic resources and inclusive communication strategies.
- Facilitated workshops for teachers and support staff on best practices in child-centered communication, fostering an inclusive school environment that prioritizes emotional and psychological well-being.
- Utilized feedback and data collection to continuously refine therapy programs, ensuring they meet the evolving needs of children and families, thus improving overall service delivery.
- Engaged with families to provide support and guidance, empowering them to actively participate in their child's therapeutic journey and enhancing family dynamics.
- Led evaluation initiatives to measure the effectiveness of therapeutic approaches, resulting in improved methodologies and resources that better aligned with children's needs.

Play Therapist | Barnardos, St Helens | January 2015 - October 2016

- Designed and implemented individualized visual and therapeutic resources to support children referred through CAMHS, significantly improving their ability to navigate social and emotional challenges.
- Actively contributed to multidisciplinary assessment meetings, utilizing my expertise to recommend appropriate communication supports tailored to each child's unique needs.
- Managed a diverse caseload of school-aged children, employing creative and resource-based approaches to effectively address a wide range of social, emotional, and communication challenges.
- Facilitated group supervision sessions for fellow therapists, sharing best practices and insights on child-centered communication strategies to enhance overall service quality.
- Engaged families in the therapeutic process, providing educational resources and strategies to foster communication and emotional support at home.
- Conducted regular evaluations of therapeutic interventions, using outcome measures to assess progress and adapt strategies accordingly, ensuring children received the most effective support.
- Collaborated with external agencies to ensure a comprehensive support network for children, enhancing their overall emotional well-being and educational experience.
- Established strong rapport with children, creating a safe space that encouraged open expression and exploration of their feelings through play.

Family Session Worker | OJs, Preston | May 2023 - January 2024

- Supported families with children on the autism spectrum by creating and adapting resources that facilitated meaningful engagement and communication during therapy sessions.
- Developed and implemented inclusive activities designed to ensure that children with communication differences could participate fully and confidently in group settings.
- Collaborated closely with families and colleagues to identify individual needs, ensuring the resources created were not only practical but also user-friendly and effective.
- Facilitated workshops for families on communication strategies that promote positive interactions and understanding within the family unit.
- Monitored and assessed the impact of resources and activities on children's engagement levels, making necessary adjustments to optimize outcomes.
- Worked with a range of professionals to create a multidisciplinary approach to support, ensuring the holistic needs of each child were met.
- Encouraged parental involvement in therapeutic activities, fostering a collaborative approach to support children's development.
- Utilized creative methods to engage children, allowing them to express themselves in a safe and supportive environment.

Plan and Resource Creator | International school | N/A

- Planned and developed a suite of literacy and learning resources for primary-aged children, ensuring alignment with curriculum objectives and child engagement.
- Created dynamic and visually engaging classroom materials that supported reading and writing development, fostering a love for learning among students.
- Collaborated with teachers to create tailored resources that addressed diverse learning needs, ensuring every child had access to personalized learning opportunities.
- Adapted activities to suit various learning levels, allowing for differentiated instruction that catered to the unique strengths and challenges of each student.
- Utilized feedback from educators to continuously improve resource effectiveness, ensuring they remained relevant and impactful in the classroom setting.
- Implemented innovative teaching methods that actively involved students in their learning journey, promoting engagement and retention.
- Conducted training sessions for teachers on the effective use of newly developed resources, ensuring proper implementation and maximizing educational impact.
- Monitored the effectiveness of resources through assessments and feedback, resulting in ongoing improvements that enhanced student learning outcomes.

EDUCATION

BSc | University of Central Lancashire

 SKILLS

Mind Express 5

Widgit Online)

Knowledge of AAC symbol systems (PCS

SymbolStix

Widgit

Bliss

Strong digital skills for resource creation

layout

and design

Collaboration with therapists

educators

and families to ensure resources meet user needs

reflecting a holistic approach to therapy.

 HOBBIES



Travel



Reading



Photography



Music



Swimming



Fitness



Writing



Meditation



Art

 CERTIFICATIONS

DDP (Diadic Developmental Psychotherapy) Health & Social Care (Preston College) - Gained in-depth knowledge of therapeutic approaches that foster attachment and emotional regulation in children.

Play Therapy (Canterbury Christ University) - Developed skills in utilizing play as a therapeutic tool to facilitate communication and healing in children.

Filial Therapy in Family Therapy (Manchester) - Acquired techniques to engage families in the therapeutic process, enhancing family dynamics and support systems.